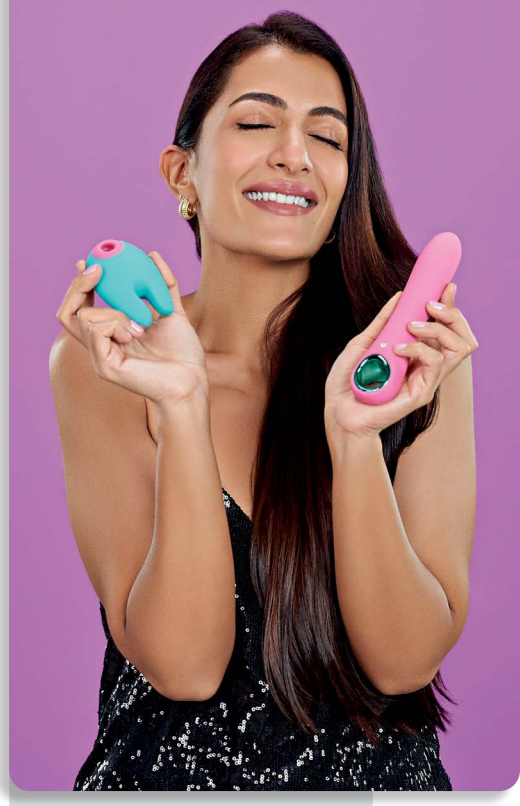


SOCIAL MEDIA

The Pleasure **Squad**

With the new crop of **sex-ed content creators** gaining popularity on social media, India is finally getting ready to unlearn the years of conditioning around sex and sexuality



"When I was young, the Aamir Khan-starrer *Raja Hindustani* featured a kiss between the lead pair. As Khan and Karisma Kapoor leaned closer, the camera panned out further and further. It was implied that they were kissing but you couldn't see the act in detail," recalls Dr Tanaya Narendra, an internationally-trained medical doctor, author, embryologist, and scientist, popularly known as dr_cuterus on social media channels.

"Cut to today, when *Gehraiyaan*'s trailer came out a few years ago; it was nothing but a montage of kissing scenes. It's heartening to see that the greater conversation around sexuality and intimacy has shifted, which is leading to this change," she adds.

Whether it's the acceptance of films like *Thank You For Coming* or *Lipstick Under My Burkha* where women's pleasure is at the



SUJATA SETIA

INTERVIEW

Stories of **Influence**

Author, mythologist and sexual health influencer ***Seema Anand*** *is working on a new book on relationships*

Q **You use stories as a medium to dismantle the stigma around sex and drive change. How did it all begin?**

Stories are the most powerful tool of communication and influence. If you look at any story in the past, the woman's body is always someone else's property. You always hear about the chaste women—there are no stories ever told about women who have the power to enjoy their bodies. It has been propagated through the narrative that until you get your period, you are a *devi* or goddess and have to be worshipped. After that, you suddenly